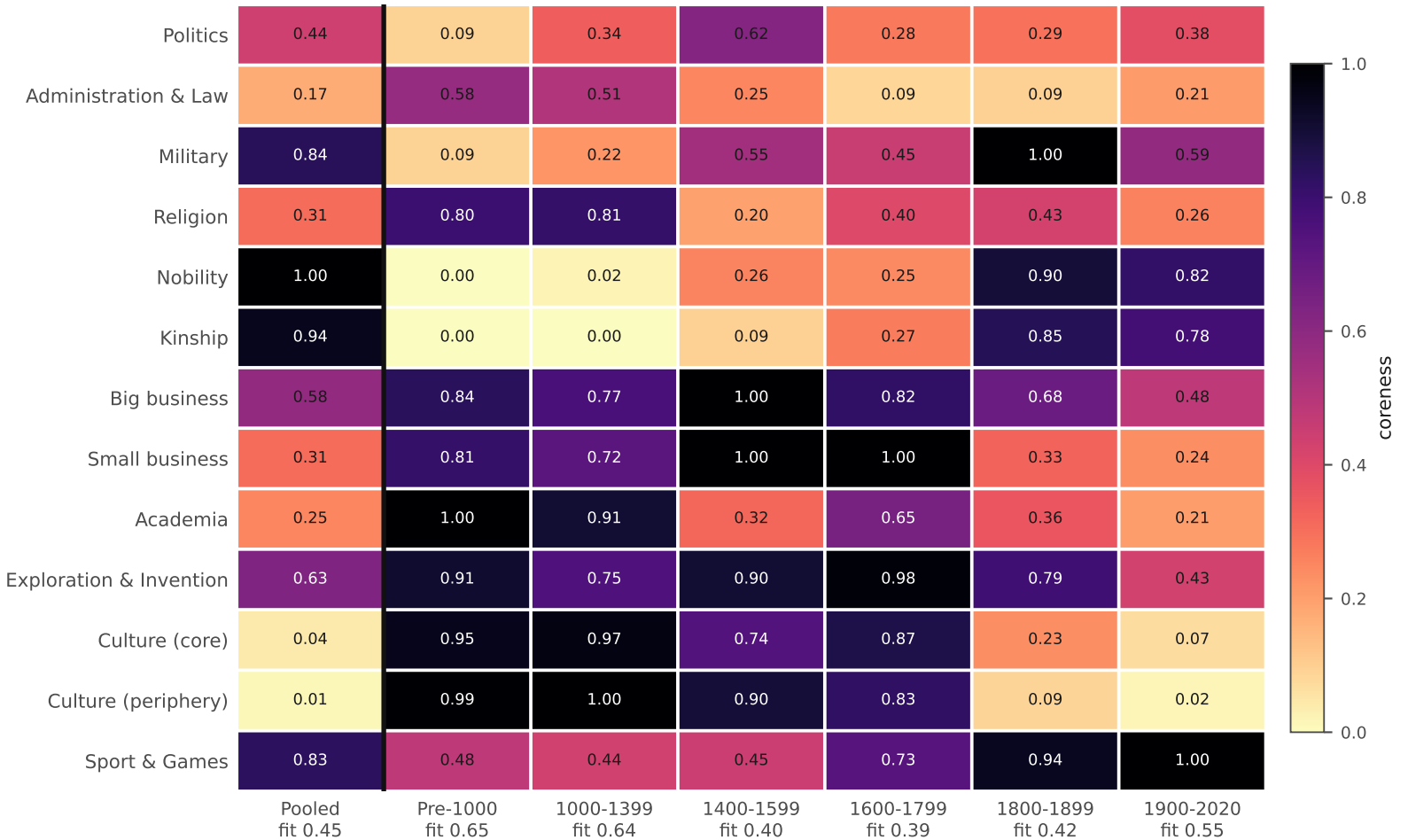


Who sits at the centre of the positive ties



Coreness is the leading eigenvector of the positive part of the association matrix, its best rank-one approximation, rescaled so the largest score is one. It reads as membership of the tightest positive cluster and not as importance. The centre changes hands: culture and the academy hold it before 1400, nobility, kinship and the military after 1800. The fit printed under each column says how well one core with a periphery around it describes that era at all, and it never exceeds 0.65 in any era. Source: BHHT cross-verified database of notable people (Laouenan et al., Scientific Data 9:290, 2022).